

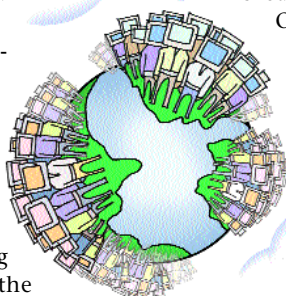
The billionth PC

The personal computer industry has passed a historical milestone as the one-billionth PC was shipped in April this year, according to a Gartner Dataquest research. While it took 25 years for one billion PCs to ship out, Gartner predicts that the two billionth PC will ship out in just six years' time. In 2008, the PC industry is projected to reach the milestone of 2 billion PCs, with the greatest growth opportunity coming from

high emerging markets in places such as China, Latin America and Eastern Europe. The Asia-Pacific region ranked as the third major regional market, with more than 100 million PCs being shipped to the region.

The report also predicts that the PC industry will get a

big boost in the next few years from ubiquitous broadband services. Once broadband services are available everywhere at data rates exceeding 10 Mbps, the PC will become the central appliance that manages communications and entertainment in homes. Here's to the next 1 billion PCs!



redalert

JPEG virus

Here's something that you don't see very often—a virus that affects JPEG images. Called Perrun, the virus appends itself to JPG files and requires an extractor to extract and execute the virus code. It arrives in the form of an 11,780 byte portable executable or EXE file. When executed, the 5,636 byte extractor component (EXTRK.EXE) is dropped to the current directory and a system Registry key is modified.

Perrun is relatively harmless. Systems without the Perrun extractor component are not affected when they open an infected JPEG file and if the extractor is installed, you are safe as long as you don't open infected JPEG files. To prevent infection, ensure that your anti-virus software is updated. Also check if the size of JPEG files has increased by the specified amount.

Shakira's here for the monsoons

The latest Internet worm spreads by inviting you to open an infected mail that promises to display pictures of pop star Shakira. The VBS/VBSWG.aq@MM worm contains the subject line, 'Shakira's Pictures', with the body of the mail reading, 'Hi : i have sent the photos via attachment Have funn...'. The attachment has the file-name 'ShakiraPics.jpg.vbs'.

It spreads via Outlook and Internet Relay Chat (IRC) and overwrites .vbs and .vbe files with its own code. However, the damage caused is minimal. Install the latest virus updates for your anti-virus software and delete any suspicious e-mails.

4G in India

India's Ministry of Information Technology has formed a new wireless technology group to develop the fourth-generation wireless standard. The plan is based on a study by Vinay Deshpande, former president of the Manufacturers' Association for Information Technology and H.S. Jamadagni, a professor at the Indian Institute of Science.

Snail mail meets e-mail

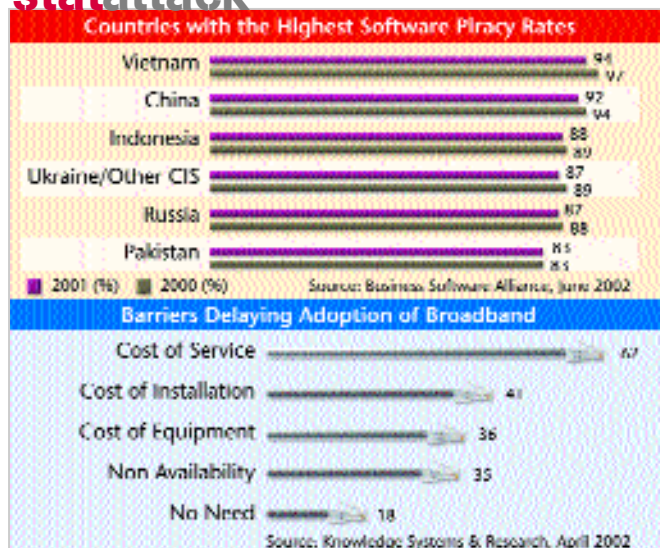
In what could be termed as an interesting experiment, China plans to marry e-mail and snail-mail to provide a convenient alternative to Internet users. China Post, the official Chinese postal service, will soon introduce the service which will allow anyone with a computer to type an e-mail, send it across to the postal service, where the mail will be printed, put



in an envelope and be hand delivered to its destination. There is a large potential market: according to government figures, mainland China had 33.7 million Internet users at the end of last year. In a country of 1.3 billion, that means only a tiny fraction has access to e-mail.

The Chinese postal service hopes to bridge this digital divide by attracting medium-sized and small companies along with appropriate entrepreneurs with this offering. Although the relatively high-cost of the service will initially keep individuals away, hopes are that the venture will take off and eventually drive costs down to a level that will be affordable by the common man.

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